

Cherry — DealFlow Product Strategy

Product definition, customer experience, capabilities, roadmap and continuous evolution

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1. Product Definition

DealFlow is a configurable real-estate business operating platform that organizes existing and new business data, manages the complete lead-to-deal lifecycle, ensures every opportunity has a clear next action, and brings leads, customers, properties, follow-ups, visits, documents, deals and operations into one simple workspace.

Product design principle

Complexity belongs inside the system; the customer's daily experience should remain simple.

2. Core Product Model

The product must support both existing business data and newly created data.

Historical / imported data

- Preserve source and import context.
- Keep imported records distinguishable from actively managed records.
- Support review, verification, activation, archival and reactivation.
- Never silently overwrite or destroy original information.

Managed / active data

- Leads, customers, requirements, properties, follow-ups, visits, negotiations, documents, deals and closures.
- Every important active record has status, owner, next action, timing and history.

3. Central User Experience

The central experience is Today's Attention: what requires action now, what is overdue, what is upcoming and what opportunities may otherwise be forgotten.

Users should be able to understand the state of their business without navigating multiple modules.

4. End-to-End Lifecycle

Contact → Lead → Qualification → Requirement → Property Match → Shortlist → Follow-up → Site Visit → Feedback → Negotiation → Documentation → Booking/Deal → Payment → Commission → Closure → Referral.

The exact stages must be configurable because brokers, agencies, builders and channel partners operate differently.

5. Core Modules

Contacts and customer profiles.

Lead management and qualification.

Customer requirements.

Property inventory.

Property matching.

Follow-up and task management.

Lead and deal pipeline.

Activity/timeline history.

Site visits and feedback.

Deal workspace.

Document tracking.

Payments and commission tracking as the product matures.

Notifications and automation.

Dashboards and analytics.

Import, migration and data-quality management.

Roles, permissions and audit.

6. Data Onboarding

The product should accept Excel/CSV and other supported structured sources as a first-class workflow.

Import flow

- Upload data.
- Analyze columns and record types.
- Detect duplicates and missing information.
- Suggest mappings.
- Allow user review and corrections.
- Preview the resulting records.
- Import with an identifiable batch/history.
- Report the result and unresolved issues.

Imported historical records should not automatically become active leads merely because they exist in a file.

7. Simple Data Entry

New records should use progressive capture. Ask for the minimum information required to create a useful record, then allow details to be added as the workflow progresses.

Provide quick add, bulk operations, sensible defaults, search, duplicate detection and merge workflows.

Natural-language input can later convert customer messages or notes into structured information.

8. Lead Intelligence

Separate process status from customer interest and outcome.

Process status: New, Contacted, Qualified, Matching, Visit, Negotiation, Won, Lost, On Hold.

Interest: Unknown, Low, Medium, High, Very High.

Outcome captures what actually happened.

This separation prevents one overloaded status field from becoming confusing.

9. Follow-Up Intelligence

Due, overdue, upcoming, waiting and triggered follow-ups should be visible.

A follow-up can be generated by an event such as a completed site visit or by an SLA/condition.

The product should eventually explain why a lead needs attention and suggest the next action.

10. Property and Matching

Property records should remain simple at first while supporting advanced attributes as needed.

Matching should compare customer requirements against inventory and explain the reasons for a match.

The product should support different property types and operating models without creating separate products.

11. Site Visits, Deals and Documents

Site visits: schedule → confirm → remind → conduct → record feedback → create next action.

Deal workspace: customer, property, negotiation, tasks, documents, payments, approvals, communication and timeline in one place.

Documents: required, uploaded, verified, rejected, expired, pending, with ownership and audit history.

12. Configurability

One core product should support different businesses through configurable pipelines, fields, roles, statuses, notifications, workflows, dashboards and approval rules.

Avoid customer-specific forks and custom code wherever a reusable configuration model can solve the problem.

13. AI Strategy

AI should reduce work inside existing workflows rather than become a separate complicated interface.

Initial capabilities: extraction, summaries, requirement understanding, property matching, next-action recommendations and message drafting.

AI must not invent availability, prices, legal facts or customer commitments.

Important actions should pass through identity, permission, policy, risk and approval controls, with auditability.

14. Continuous Product Evolution

V1 is a milestone, not a finished product.

Product improvements should be driven by customer evidence, analytics, support patterns, operational pain and strategic opportunities.

Every release should improve functionality, reliability, security, performance, usability, automation, observability or customer value.

Use controlled releases, feature flags, migrations, versioning and deprecation practices as the product matures.

15. V1 Product Scope

Organization/authentication foundation.

Contacts.

Data import.

Leads.

Requirements.

Properties.

Matching.

Follow-ups.

Timeline/history.

Pipeline.

Today's Attention.

Basic dashboard.

Basic document tracking.

Audit/history.

16. Expansion Roadmap

V1.1: site visits, feedback, deal workspace, stronger documents, notifications and bulk operations.

V1.2: automation, roles/permissions, approvals, advanced imports and integrations.

V1.3: AI assistance, AI matching, summaries, drafting and business intelligence.

Later: builder projects, units, channel partners, payments, commissions, multi-branch and advanced integrations.